

Founded: 1996

Sector: Anti-Trafficking, Survivor Rehabilitation, Prevention

Prajwala was established in 1996 by Sunitha Krishnan and Brother Jose Vetticatil in Hyderabad to combat sex trafficking and commercial sexual exploitation in India's red-light areas. It pioneered holistic interventions focusing on rescue, rehabilitation, and second-generation prevention for children of prostituted women.

Founded by Sunitha Krishnan (survivor advocate) after personal trauma and activism, Prajwala grew from a single school in a vacated red-light area to the world's largest anti-trafficking shelter. It tackled intergenerational prostitution through education centers, vocational training, and police partnerships, rescuing 28,600+ survivors while preventing thousands of children from entering sex trade. By 2026, operates 17 transition centers --

emphasizing economic reintegration amid rising cyber-trafficking challenges

Service Categories:

Prevention: Second-generation programs educating 6,000+ children of sex workers across 17 centers to break trafficking cycles.

Rescue & Rehabilitation: Crisis counseling, shelter for HIV+ survivors, vocational skills (carpentry, welding, printing, housekeeping) for economic independence.

PRAJWALA'S MISSION



PRAJWALA'S IMPACT OVER THE YEARS

- 28,816 women and children removed from places of exploitation (till dec 2025).
- 27,060 individuals were provided with rehabilitation services
- 20,005 children vulnerable children prevented from prostitution
- 8 million awakened on harms of sex trafficking.
- 189 traffickers convicted
- 2421 sex buyers reformed
- 5 state policies for victim protection, 1 state policy to combat human trafficking and witch hunting and one central legislation(Bill) to combat trafficking
- National Cyber-crime portal and intermediary guidelines

PRAJWALA OPERATIONS: *To End Sex Trafficking & Sex Crime*

Prevention	Rescue	Rehabilitation	Reintegration	Advocacy
Prajwala has designed interventions to prevent sex trafficking at the source through education and awareness and at the destination by confronting the demand. The aim of the prevention intervention is two-fold. At one end to engage with the potential victims and provide them education and awareness and at the other address the persons responsible to generate demand for behaviour modification.	Rescue victims of sexual assault and sex trafficking and provide them legal and psychological support to prevent their re-trafficking and assist in prosecution. Rescue victims from sex slavery Map profiles of perpetrators for prevention of more being forced into sexual slavery Counsel (Legal and Psychological) and support survivors and their families Support for civic and social reintegration	Rehabilitation is the sum total of multiple processes including psychological healing,economic empowerment and a civic identity.All this leads to the successful integration of a survivor in the society.Although institutional care ideally is the last option, there is absolutely no doubt that temporary/transit institutionalization is inevitable to facilitate holistic rehabilitation.	Social reintegration is the ultimate aim of all rehabilitation programs.Preparations for it is built at the entry level itself with every step moving towards preparing the survivor for a life outside.Reintegration consists of the survivor being able to live in the mainstream world with dignity. Most victims who have come to Prajwala for support are survivors today living and adjusting in the normal mainstream society.	Advocacy for better victim centric policies and legislations benefits a larger constituency across the country. It is through media advocacy that an enabling environment is created for better implementation of victim centric policies and legislations.